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4-5-46

Dearest one -

It was one o'clock at the Darrough mansion - I had just taken my bath - put up my hair and was getting ready to hit the sack (looking like a witch right out of "Harrison's Fairy Tales"), Marylenn had just come in from her date - Justin had just come in from a movie all slicked up in his R.S.C. uniform and we were just sitting there chewing the fat - laughing when the door bell rang. I answered it expecting a telegram - But the outline of a burly marine donned the doorway. A shriek "Erwin" He picked me up, swung me around, kissed me - set me down - In a moment the household was humming with activity - It wasn't a minute later that Daddy & Mother and the kids all came down.

Then there was a hushed silence and for a minute or two no one said anything. Mother was crying and I detected a tremor in Daddy's voice as he said "Welcome home, Son". Then suddenly - I really felt very ashamed. The things that gripe me - the things that get me down are nothing to what my parents have been through these past few years. The lines of worry and apprehension seemed to disappear from their faces and they seemed

to straighten us if a burden had been lifted from their shoulders. And suddenly they looked years younger again and the household burst once more into the merriment of before. It was the most touching scene I have ever witnessed and I'll never forget it.

Erwin is a great kid. He's 6'3" and has gotten pretty thin. He's changed an awful lot - a little more independent - rather nervous and an old salt.

He brought home quite a few Japanese souvenirs and some stuff from China. It's really great to see him and he explained about his not writing - which is clearly understandable now.

He's getting ready to go downtown now and I'll never see such prancing, polishing etc. in my life. He's really proud of that uniform.

This letter is just to let you know that I'll be back Sunday night. I'm leaving on the New York Central - leaves here 5:40 p.m. and should arrive in St. Louis 11:00 p.m. and the trains have been running on schedule pretty well. So I suppose I'll be on time. I'd love to stay over until my

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Allotted time of the 11th - but I can't afford it - so
these three days are really going to make time.

I won't be writing again - so
I was afraid an ordinary letter wouldn't get to you
here closing before Monday.

With all my love with all my heart

All my life

Martha

I love you so much.

T. P. Hello to your family for me.